

Growing Together — Module 03: Perception — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. What is the first thing you notice when you wake up? (Light? A voice? The smell of breakfast?).
2. Can you tell if someone is smiling just by hearing their voice?
3. Why does food taste bland when you have a cold? (Smell is part of taste!).
4. How does your body tell you it is full? (Tummy feeling — that is interoception!).
5. What does "Hangry" mean? (Hungry + Angry). Why does this happen?
6. If you could not see, how would you find your way around the house?
7. Do you think the dog perceives smells better than you? (Yes, much better!).
8. Why is it hard to listen when the TV is on? (Too much sensory input).
9. How can you tell if someone wants a hug? (Open arms? Sad face?).
10. What is your favorite smell in your house? (Cookies? Laundry? Coffee?).

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Go on a "Sense Walk" around your house. Write down one thing you See, Hear, Smell, Touch, and Taste in each room. Which room has the most interesting senses?
2. Close your eyes for one minute. What sounds can you hear that you did not notice before? The brain filters out sounds it expects!
3. Try eating a snack with your eyes closed. Does the food taste different when you cannot see it? Write about what you noticed.
4. Play "Emotion Detective": Look at each family member's face right now without asking. Guess how they are feeling. Then check — were you right?
5. Put your hand on your chest and feel your heartbeat. Now jump ten times and feel it again. What changed? Your body is sending you a signal!
6. Find three things in your house that feel very different (smooth, rough, soft). Close your eyes and touch each one. Can you identify them by touch alone?

7. Make a "Sensory Map" of your favorite room. Draw the room and label where the sounds, smells, sights, and textures come from.
8. Sit quietly with a family member for two minutes. Without talking, try to sense how they are feeling. After two minutes, share what you noticed about each other.
9. Create a "Perception Challenge" for someone: hide an object and give only sensory clues ("It is soft, it smells like flowers, it makes no sound"). Can they find it?
10. At bedtime, close your eyes and notice three things your body is telling you. Are you tired? Warm? Relaxed? Thank your inside senses for keeping you informed.